

I saw what I saw

Woodwork is easy if you know how some of the basic tools we just discussed work. It seems more appropriate to get started with the saw because your first step will always be to figure out how big a piece of wood you will need and use a saw to cut a piece out.

Getting down to the saw, the first thing you need to know about saws is that they have teeth and in a majority of them, only one side is sharp, which is usually the side facing you. So, the cutting happens only when you pull the saw towards you.

While sawing, step one is to always start off by drawing a cut line. It's usually with a pencil and involves measuring two times before actually drawing it. Step two is making a starting cut. Some people like to put the saw down against the line and slowly cut through the wood, but the correct way to do it is to put your thumb right next to cut line with the nail facing out and place the saw on the cut line. You're essentially using your nail to help guide your saw to the cut line.

Once the starting cut is made, the saw now has a groove to move across. Grip the saw firmly, but not too tight and push the saw against the wood. Angle it slightly downwards and feel the teeth catch the wood. On the second stroke, angle the saw up, so that the teeth slide off with minimum resistance.



Also remember to stick your pointer out. It serves to point your saw along the line.